

Zardari Serving Second Term as President of Pakistan

ISLAMABAD -- Asif Ali Zardari is the current President of Pakistan, having assumed office as the 14th President on 10 March 2024. This is his second term in the role, having previously served as the 11th President of Pakistan from September 2008 to September 2013.

Zardari's re-election makes him the first civilian in Pakistan's history to serve two non-consecutive presidential terms. He succeeded Arif Alvi, who served as the 13th President from September 2018 to March 2024.

As President, Zardari serves as the ceremonial head of state and ceremonial commander-in-chief of the Pakistan Armed Forces, while executive authority in Pakistan's parliamentary system rests primarily with the Prime Minister, currently Shehbaz Sharif. The President's official residence is the Aiwan-e-Sadr in Islamabad.

Zardari currently heads the Pakistan Peoples Party, a position he has held since December 2015. His political career has spanned several decades, including serving as a federal minister in the 1990s under Prime Minister Benazir Bhutto, to whom he was married.

Under Pakistan's constitution, the President is elected by an electoral college for a term of five years, renewable once consecutively. The office was first established in 1956, with Iskander Mirza serving as its inaugural holder.